

Aristea of the Shifting Tides

Domain-Constrained Nereus Obedience Guide

Ancient knowledge. Fluid form. The strength of the sea.

Decision summary

Best package	Creator / Rite of Passage / Sacred Crafting
Alternative	Discerning Mind / Poisoned Mysticism / Adaptive Flesh and Twisting Steel
Eligible domains	Knowledge, Shapeshifting, Sea/Water

Aristea is a level-17 Intelligence-based Wizard/Arcane Trickster, water-and-cold specialist, primary crafter, merchant-mage, and accomplished shapeshifter. Knowledge and Shapeshifting are player-confirmed Nereus themes; Sea/Water follows the campaign record and Nereus's identity.

The primary package is the strongest campaign-economy line for Aristea as primary crafter: Knowledge, Shapeshifting, then Knowledge/Crafting. Rally Crew replaces Sacred Crafting for the strongest fleet-command line, while the alternative is the strongest personal combat-caster line. Rally Crew is a direct Sea/Water and Weather fit, but its heroism bonuses do not stack with other morale bonuses of the same type.

Prepared 22 July 2026 | Pathfinder 1e | Campaign-specific analysis

Rules frame

The campaign allows a custom obedience assembled from published boons: tier 1 must stay tier 1, tier 2 must stay tier 2, and tier 3 must stay tier 3, while source deity, category, and prestige path may be mixed. This guide adds the required domain-fit filter.

Admissible domains: Knowledge, Shapeshifting, Sea/Water

The printed action, uses, duration, target restrictions, bonus type, descriptor, and other mechanics remain intact unless the GM approves a change. The normal obedience feats generally grant boons at 12, 16, and 20 Hit Dice; prestige classes can accelerate access.

Nereus does not yet have a formal post-schism domain line in the campaign wiki. Knowledge and Shapeshifting are player-confirmed themes, and Sea/Water follows the campaign record and his identity as the Old Man of the Sea. Final GM confirmation is still required.

Rating scale

S: defining option. **A:** excellent. **B:** useful but narrower, redundant, or less efficient. Plus and minus signs distinguish choices inside a grade.

Already acquired divine rewards

OW

N

S

Animal Lord of the Tides

Nereus - Campaign Boons | Fit: Sea/Water, Shapeshifting

Acquired campaign template - not a published tier boon.

Sacred narwhal form, underwater operation, senses, and transformation. This should shape the obedience choices but should not consume a tier unless the GM merges the systems.

Acquired rewards are graded in place. They are not automatically assumed to consume obedience slots; that is a campaign ruling the GM must settle.

Tier 1 - Top 10

Tier 1 is about repeatable utility and thematic foundations. At level 17, flexibility matters more than low spell level.

1	A+	Creator Brigh - Exalted 1 Fit: Knowledge, Crafting	Crafter's fortune 3/day, make whole 2/day, or minor creation 1/day. The best tier-1 package for Aristeia's primary-crafter role.
2	A	Discerning Mind Otolmens - Monitor 1 Fit: Knowledge	Identify 3/day, investigative mind 2/day, or blink 1/day. The first two are strong knowledge tools; blink is useful defense.
3	A-	Secret Lore Abraxas - Demoniac/Exalted 1 Fit: Knowledge	Identify 3/day, augury 2/day, or illusory script 1/day. Strong divination access with an ancient-secret flavor.
4	A-	Magical Essences Nethys - Exalted 1 Fit: Knowledge	Magic aura 3/day, misdirection 2/day, or arcane sight 1/day. Arcane sight is the strongest direct magical-information option.
5	B+	Truth in the Flesh Haagenti - Demoniac/Exalted 1 Fit: Shapeshifting	Enlarge person 3/day, alter self 2/day, or beast shape I 1/day. Perfect fit, but partly redundant with Aristeia's spellbook and Animal Lord form.

Tier 1 - Ranks 6-10

6

B+

River Guide

Hanspur - Exalted 1 | Fit: Sea/Water

Obscuring mist 3/day, haunting mists 2/day, or aqueous orb 1/day. Useful water control without prepared slots.

7

B+

Creator's Whispers

Phlegyas - Monitor 1 | Fit: Knowledge, Crafting

Crafter's fortune 3/day, object reading 2/day, or detect anxieties 1/day. A good blend of crafting and investigative knowledge.

8

B+

River Sage

Hanspur - Evangelist 1 | Fit: Sea/Water

Hydraulic push 3/day, river whip 2/day, or hydraulic torrent 1/day. Reusable thematic battlefield control.

9

B

Enslave the Sea

Dagon - Evangelist 1 | Fit: Sea/Water

Hydraulic push 3/day, slipstream 2/day, or water breathing 1/day. Useful at sea, but several effects overlap existing capabilities.

10

B

Fearsome Boast

Besmara - Sentinel 1 | Fit: Sea/Water

Monkey fish 3/day, slipstream 2/day, or water breathing 1/day. Practical maritime utility with substantial redundancy.

Tier 2 - Top 10

Tier 2 contains the build-shaping engines. These rankings weigh both domain purity and how often the boon changes play.

1

S

Rite of Passage

[Lymnieris](#) - Celestial Mystery Cultist 2 | Fit: Shapeshifting

Greater polymorph 1/day on a willing creature, permanent until Aristeia or the target dismisses it or Aristeia uses the boon again. Perfect Nereus fit; only one active transformation is supported.

2

S

Poisoned Mysticism

[Abraxas](#) - Evangelist 2 | Fit: Knowledge

Adds Intelligence to concentration and caster-level checks for spell resistance and dispelling; printed poison benefits remain. Excellent for Intelligence 34, but adapt the toxic flavor as secret sea lore with GM approval.

3

A+

Borrowed Memories

[Shyka](#) - Feysworn 2 | Fit: Knowledge

Immediate, best-result legend lore 1/day regardless of the subject's location. The cleanest pure Knowledge-domain boon.

4

A+

Aspect of Ishiar

[Dagon](#) - Evangelist 2 | Fit: Sea/Water, Shapeshifting

Become seawater for 10 minutes/Hit Die/day: DR 10/slashing, +10-foot reach, infiltration through cracks, Stealth, water subtype, amphibious breathing, and swim 60 feet.

5

A

Transformation Mastery

[Xhamen-Dor](#) - Sentinel 2 | Fit: Shapeshifting

+2 DC to polymorph effects, doubled self-polymorph durations, shapechanger subtype, and +2 profane saves while transformed. The Charisma damage rider is minor for Aristeia.

Tier 2 - Ranks 6-10

6

A

Arcane Eye

[Nethys](#) - Evangelist 2 | Fit: Knowledge

Arcane eye 3/day enhanced with arcane sight. Excellent remote reconnaissance and magical analysis.

7

A-

Doom of Sailors

[Besmara](#) - Sentinel 2 | Fit: Sea/Water

Control water or control winds 1/day. Naval-scale control with direct Nereus fit, though Aristeia may already prepare similar spells.

8

A-

Improve Item

[Bharnarol](#) - Mystery Cultist 2 | Fit: Knowledge, Crafting

Three times/day as a swift action, apply Empower, Enlarge, or Extend to a consumed or charged magic item used that round.

9

A-

Blessing of Sea and Storm

[Hei Feng](#) - Exalted 2 | Fit: Sea/Water, Crafting

Turn rainwater or seawater into a temporary potion of a prepared qualifying spell of 4th level or lower. Uses/day equal Charisma modifier, minimum one.

10

B+

River Traveler

[Hanspur](#) - Exalted 2 | Fit: Sea/Water

Grant self and nearby allies swim 60 feet as a free action for Hit Dice rounds, plus +2 saves against water-descriptor spells.

Tier 3 - Top 11

Tier 3 is the capstone. These abilities should justify the slot in epic and mythic play, not merely imitate a routine spell.

1

S+

Sacred Crafting

Torag - Evangelist 3 | Fit: Knowledge, Crafting

Reduce the calculated base cost of every crafted magic item by 10%; the boon explicitly reduces crafting time and final price as well. Also grants fabricate 1/day.

2

S+

Rally Crew

Besmara - Exalted 3 | Fit: Sea/Water, Weather

Once/day, every ally within 60 feet gains +10 feet of speed and heroism for 1 hour/Hit Die. Benefited attack rolls, saves, and skill checks ignore water- or weather-based penalties. At level 17 it lasts 17 hours and can cover a gathered crew.

3

S+

Adaptive Flesh and Twisting Steel

Haagenti - Sentinel 3 | Fit: Shapeshifting

Shapechange 1/day, expanded form options, and equipment alters so it continues functioning in polymorphed forms. The strongest combat capstone for Aristeia.

4

S

Truth in the Flesh

Socothbenoth - Demonic/Exalted 3 | Fit: Shapeshifting

Shapechange 1/day. Mechanically clean and extremely flexible, but without the equipment-preservation rider.

5

A+

Transmogrify

Bharnarol - Mystery Cultist 3 | Fit: Shapeshifting, Knowledge

Extended polymorph any object 1/day. Exceptional transformation, infiltration, utility, and problem-solving.

Tier 3 - Ranks 6-11

6

A+

Inspired Crafting

Brigh - Exalted 3 | Fit: Knowledge, Crafting

While adventuring, 4 hours of crafting produces 4 hours of progress instead of only 2. Also grants fabricate 1/day. Excellent aboard a traveling ship.

7

A

Body of Water

Ylimancha - Mystery Cultist 3 | Fit: Sea/Water, Shapeshifting

Permanent fluid body, immunity to critical hits and sneak attacks, and movement through extremely small spaces. Confirm polymorph and Animal Lord interactions.

8

A

Pure Magic Aura

Nethys - Exalted 3 | Fit: Knowledge

For up to 6 rounds/day, Aristeia and allies within 20 feet gain +1d4 caster levels, affecting spell qualities and spell-resistance checks.

9

A-

River's Embodiment

Hanspur - Evangelist 3 | Fit: Sea/Water, Shapeshifting

Huge water elemental form 1/day for 1 minute/Hit Die. A clean Nereus expression, but less flexible than shapechange.

10

A-

Revise Reality

Otolmens - Monitor 3 | Fit: Knowledge

Limited wish 1/day. Broad problem-solving from a knowledge-and-calculation source, but less tied to Aristeia's signature roles.

11

B+

Horror of the Deep

Dagon - Sentinel 3 | Fit: Sea/Water, Shapeshifting

Deep-sea hybrid form for 1 minute/Hit Die/day with pressure immunity, water breathing, doubled swim speed, bite, and grappling tentacle.

Selection and order

Primary recommendation

Creator / Rite of Passage / Sacred Crafting

Alternative recommendation

Discerning Mind / Poisoned Mysticism / Adaptive Flesh and Twisting Steel

The primary package is the strongest campaign-economy line for Aristeia as primary crafter: Knowledge, Shapeshifting, then Knowledge/Crafting. Rally Crew replaces Sacred Crafting for the strongest fleet-command line, while the alternative is the strongest personal combat-caster line. Rally Crew is a direct Sea/Water and Weather fit, but its heroism bonuses do not stack with other morale bonuses of the same type.

Options removed by the domain rule

- Tanagaar's Hunter's Edge is excluded: sneak attack does not fit Knowledge, Shapeshifting, or Sea/Water.
- Andirifkhu's Subtle Razor is excluded for the same reason, despite its excellent damage synergy.
- Sneak-attack boons remain excluded even though they would increase ray damage; they do not fit Nereus's domains.

GM decisions before locking the package

1. Will the GM formally approve Knowledge, Shapeshifting, and Sea/Water as Nereus's custom domain list?
2. Can Poisoned Mysticism be expressed as secret oceanic lore while retaining all printed mechanics?
3. How do Body of Water and equipment-adapting polymorph effects interact with Animal Lord of the Tides?
4. Can Aristeia cast normally in the chosen permanent greater polymorph form, and can enemies dispel it?
5. Does Sacred Crafting's 10% reduction apply after every other campaign crafting modifier, as its printed sequencing states?
6. Does the normal 12/16/20 Hit Die boon schedule apply, or is access accelerated?

Practical order

At tier 1, take Creator if Aristeia remains the party's main crafter; otherwise take Discerning Mind. At tier 2, take Rite of Passage for Nereus identity or Poisoned Mysticism for caster-level contests. At tier 3, take Sacred Crafting for campaign economy, Rally Crew for fleet-wide operations, or Adaptive Flesh and Twisting Steel for personal combat and transformation.

Sources and boundaries

Mechanics were checked against the Pathfinder 1e Archives of Nethys. The campaign's mix-and-match permission is a house rule; printed obedience feats normally preserve patron and category requirements. The following source pages contain every ranked boon in this guide.

Brigh: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Brigh>

Otolmens: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Otolmens>

Abraxas: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Abraxas>

Nethys: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Nethys>

Haagenti: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Haagenti>

Hanspur: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Hanspur>

Phlegyas: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Phlegyas>

Dagon: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Dagon>

Besmara: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Besmara>

Lymnieris: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Lymnieris>

Shyka: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Shyka>

Xhamen-Dor: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Xhamen-Dor>

Bharnarol: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Bharnarol>

Hei Feng: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Hei+Feng>

Torag: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Torag>

Socothbenoth: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Socothbenoth>

Ylimancha: <https://www.aonprd.com/DeityDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Ylimancha>

Character-state basis: campaign project records current as of 22 July 2026. This document is an optimization guide, not a character-sheet mutation or final GM ruling.